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2000 - 6

## COLORADO RARE BIRD REPORT

NEOTROPIC CORMORANT  
Phalacrocorax brasilianus

Red 2/2/01 wpl

Location: Nee So Pah Reservoir; north of Lamar; Kiowa County, Colorado

Date: August 6, 2000

I was birding with Brandon Percival when we spotted this bird. It was very distant, perhaps a half mile and we were never closer than about 500 yards to it. The ID is based mainly on size and shape characteristics. Nee So Pah Res. is a flat plains reservoir without many features. The Neotropic Cormorant was initially seen perched on a stub coming out of the water. It was immediately adjacent to 100s of Double-crested Cormorants. It also swam around in company with Double-crested Cormorants. We observed the bird in our scopes. The entire observation period was for about 20 minutes. Light was good.

Description:

The overall brownish tones of this bird indicate that it was a juvenile. It was dark brown on wings, tail and body, and lighter brown (though not chalky white like Double-crested) on the head, breast and neck. I could not see features of the face. In size, it was about 20% shorter than Double-crested Cormorant. In proportions it was smaller, much slimmer, much shorter- and slimmer-necked. The bill was markedly smaller, slimmer and not as long as that of the Double-crested Cormorant. In the water, the smaller size of the bird was quite apparent, with the top of its head nearly able to pass under the chin of a Double-crested Cormorant. The tail was proportionately longer than that of the Double-crested Cormorant.

Similar Species:

The obvious I.D. contender is the Double-crested Cormorant. This bird appeared smaller, smaller-billed, more slender and with a longer tail.

Experience with Species:

I have seen many Double-crested Cormorants and quite a few Neotropic Cormorants. The most recent of these were some along the south Texas coast and around Falcon Dam in March 1994. I also seen Colorado Neotropics Cormorants, once previously at Nee So Pah Reservoir (summer of 1988).

This report was prepared from notes made at the time of observation.

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